



# Mark Zuckerberg

Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer

2004  
Founded

\$56.3B  
Q1 2026 revenue

+33%  
Revenue growth

\$135–145B  
2026 capex

3.56B  
Daily active people

## 01 Who You're Meeting

**Mark Zuckerberg** — Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, Meta.

**In role:** Founded the company in 2004 and has led it since; renamed Meta in 2021

**Today:** Sets Meta's direction and personally drives the AI programme — 2026 capital expenditure guidance of \$135–145B, the Meta Superintelligence Labs structure, and the shift from open-weight Llama toward proprietary frontier models.

He founded Facebook in 2004 and has run it for more than two decades, through successive platform bets — mobile, then the metaverse pivot that renamed the company in 2021 and absorbed tens of billions into Reality Labs, and now superintelligence. Reporting describes him personally recruiting AI researchers, meeting candidates at his own homes to assemble a team of around fifty, and maintaining close control over AI initiatives — which some employees are reported to feel limits experimentation. In March 2026 he restructured engineering teams and AI research divisions again.

**Career:** Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, Meta Platforms, Inc.; Founder, Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, Facebook, Inc. (renamed Meta in 2021)

**The company:** The only hyperscale AI spender whose infrastructure is almost entirely self-consumed — there is no Azure or AWS equivalent selling capacity to third parties. 2026 capital expenditure guidance has been raised three times to \$135–145B, roughly double the \$72.22B actually spent in 2025, while the company cuts 10% of its workforce.

**What they sell:** Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp and Reality Labs on the consumer side; the Llama open-weight model family and, from 2026, Meta Superintelligence Labs, whose first proprietary model is Muse Spark. Custom MTIA silicon is being built to reduce dependence on NVIDIA.

## 02 Where The Company Sits

Meta's relevance to an infrastructure portfolio is not as a vendor — it sells advertising, and Llama is given away. It matters as a counterparty and a demand driver. The most directly relevant fact in this research pass: in the week before Q2 2026 earnings, Meta and BlackRock announced a \$14B El Paso data centre joint venture with BlackRock funds holding 80%, which lets Meta de-consolidate significant capex from its balance sheet.

## 03 Talking Points

- Meta is not a vendor to you — it sells advertising and gives Llama away. It matters as a counterparty and a demand driver.
- The BlackRock El Paso structure is the precedent other operators will now be asked about. Understand it internally before any conversation.
- He has pivoted the company twice in five years. Treat strategic commitments as contingent on the current bet holding.

**What to pressure-test about the company:**

- Almost all capex is self-consumed — unlike Microsoft and Amazon, Meta has no third-party cloud revenue to offset the buildout
- Capex guidance raised three times to \$135–145B, roughly double 2025, while GPU-heavy assets depreciate over a 4–6 year life
- Meta extended its depreciation assumption to 5.5 years in 2025, worth nearly \$2.9B of reported profit — an accounting tailwind, not an operating one

## 04 GIP Context

**GIP:** No publicly disclosed direct GIP relationship. However, the \$14B El Paso data centre joint venture with BlackRock funds at 80% ownership is the closest adjacency of any vendor in this app — confirm internally how that structure sits relative to GIP's own digital infrastructure mandate before treating Meta as a straightforward third party.

**BlackRock:** Direct and material: a \$14B El Paso data centre joint venture announced in 2026, with BlackRock funds owning 80%. This lets Meta move significant capital expenditure off its own balance sheet while BlackRock takes the infrastructure...

**Others at Meta:** Alexandr Wang (Chief AI Officer; lead of Meta Superintelligence Labs)

[ai.meta.com](#) · [Meta Q1 2026 results](#) · [Capex analysis](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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